TRUSTMRR DATASET · 1,000 STARTUPS · FROZEN 30 JUL 2026

TrustMRR: What 1,000 Verified Startups Reveal About Real Revenue

A data-driven look at how revenue, growth, and value actually concentrate across a thousand real, API-verified businesses.

Prepared for leadership review

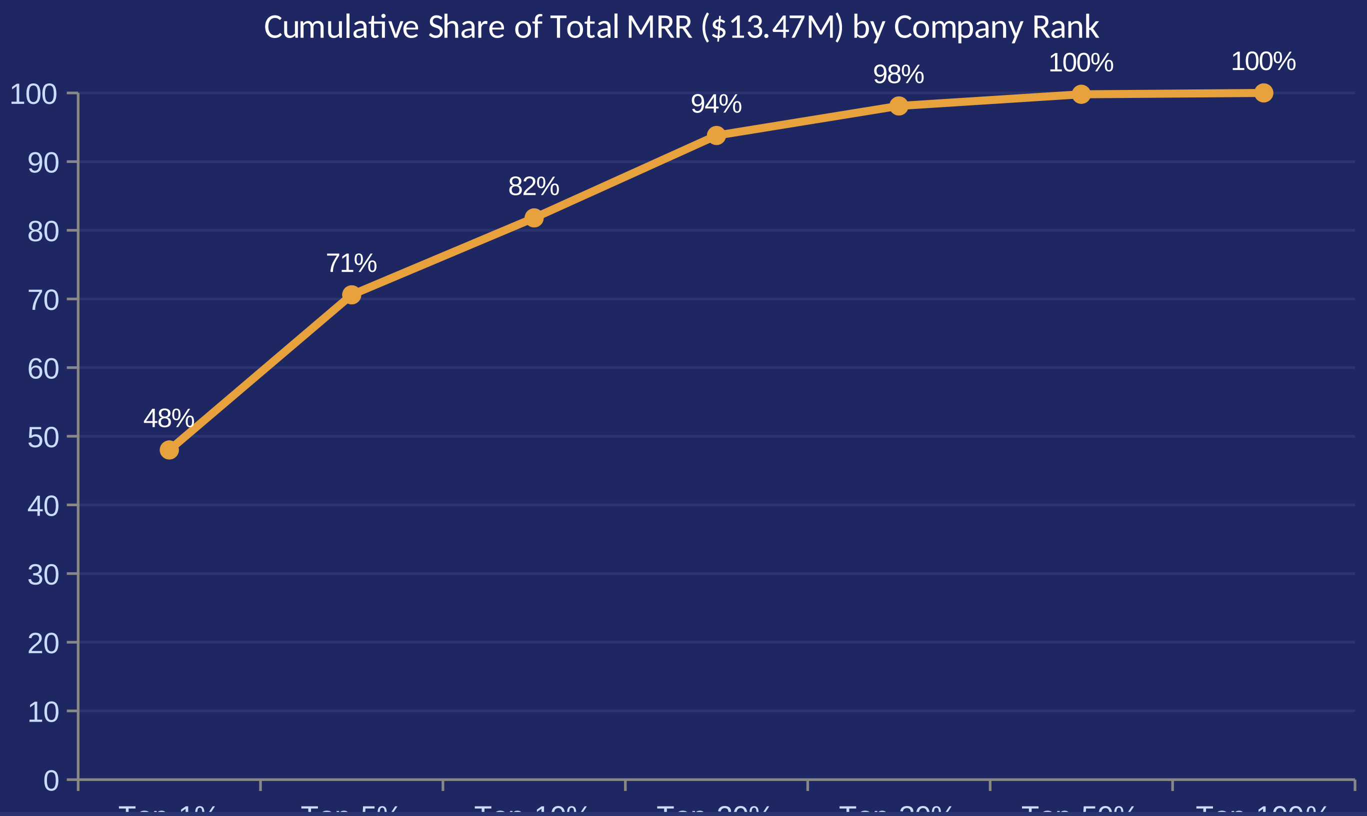
What TrustMRR Actually Measures

- TrustMRR lists real online businesses whose revenue is verified directly from payment platforms — Stripe, RevenueCat, Whop, Polar, and others — via connected API keys, not self-reported numbers.
- This analysis covers a frozen snapshot of 1,000 companies as of 30 Jul 2026, with 29 data fields per company: revenue (30-day, 3-month, 12-month, all-time), MRR, growth rate, subscriber counts, category, country, and marketplace listing status.
- Coverage skews toward web-based, English-language, US-heavy listings (258 of the 759 companies with a known country are US-based) and toward AI-labeled products (197 companies, the single largest category).

SO WHAT: This is a real-revenue cross-section of the indie and micro-SaaS economy — grounded in verified numbers, not surveys or self-reports.

THE HEADLINE

This Is a Winner-Take-Most Market



48%
of all MRR comes from just the top 10 companies

82%
of all MRR comes from the top 100 companies (10%)

$13.47M
total monthly recurring revenue across all 1,000 companies

SO WHAT: Revenue is heavily concentrated in a small number of large winners — the 'average' company in this dataset is not representative of the typical one.

Based on TrustMRR dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026

Most Companies Are Small — the Average Lies

$282 MEDIAN monthly recurring revenue (the typical company)	**$13,472** MEAN monthly recurring revenue — skewed 48x higher by a few outliers	**19.7%** of companies report $0 MRR this month	**39.4%** earn under $100/month in MRR

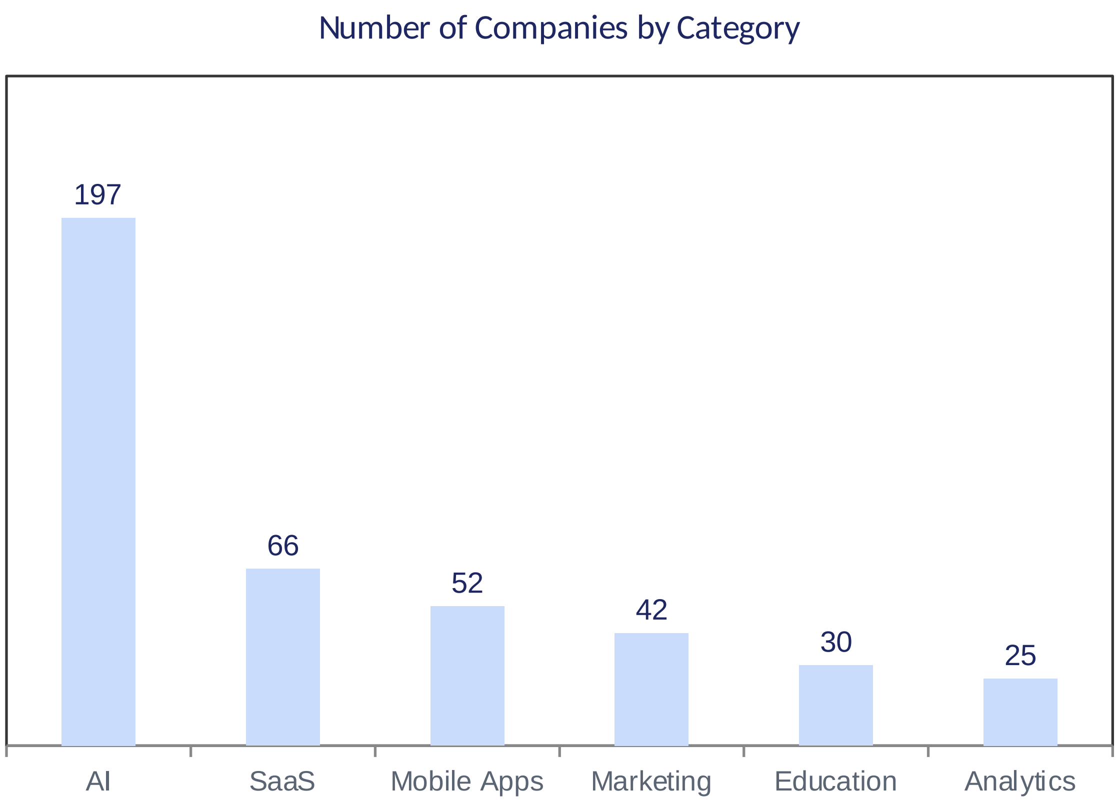
Why this matters:

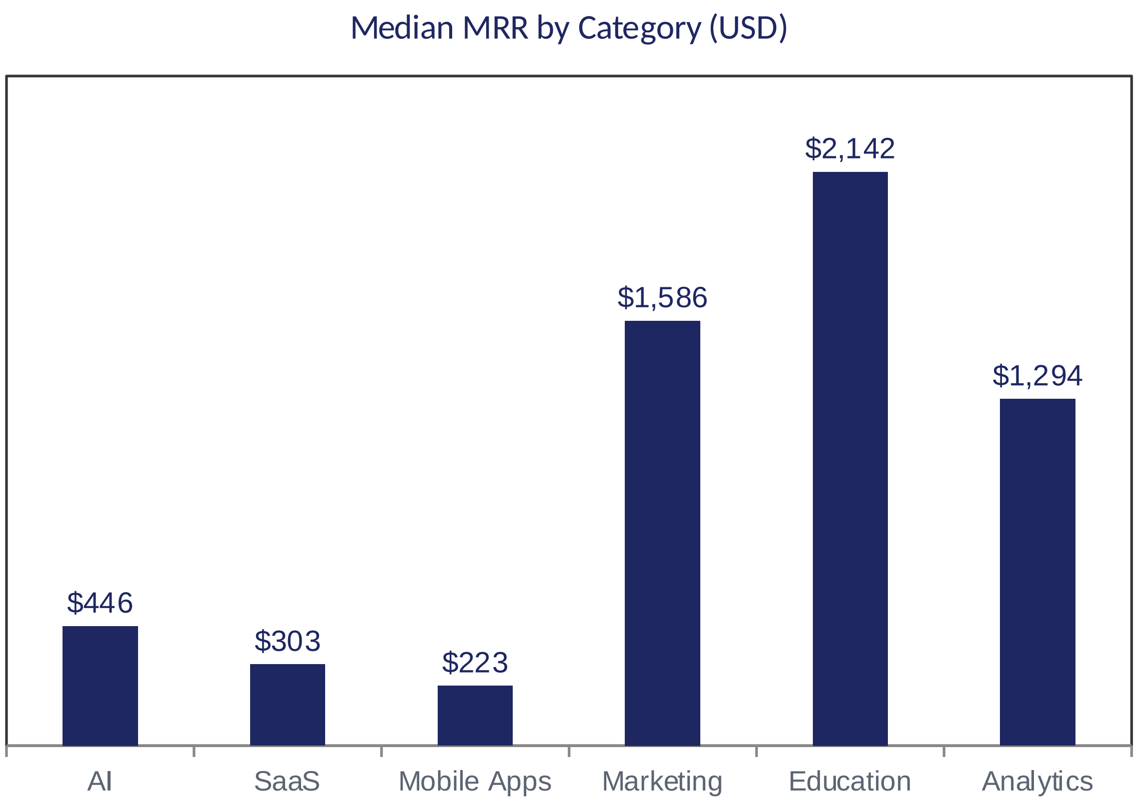
- Any single 'average revenue' figure for this dataset is misleading — it's dominated by a handful of large companies.
- Nearly 1 in 5 companies earns nothing in a given month, and roughly 2 in 5 earn less than $100/month — this is a long tail of small, early-stage, or dormant listings.
- When benchmarking or setting expectations, use the median ($282) as the realistic baseline — not the mean.

SO WHAT: The 'typical' company here earns under $300/month — plan around the median, not the mean, when setting realistic expectations.

CATEGORY SIGNAL

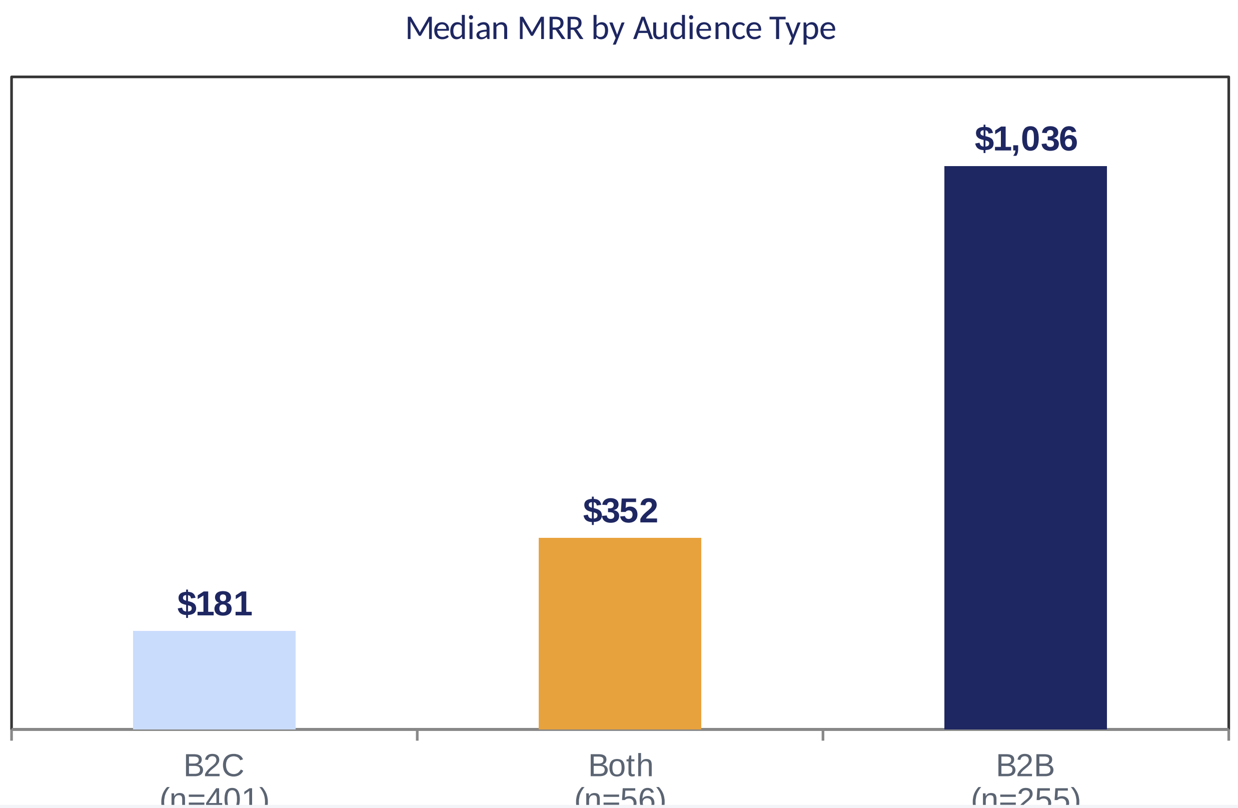
The Most Popular Category Isn't the Most Valuable





SO WHAT: AI has nearly 3x the listings of any other category, but its median MRR ($446) trails Education, Marketing, and Analytics — popularity doesn't guarantee revenue.

Who You Sell To Matters More Than What You Sell



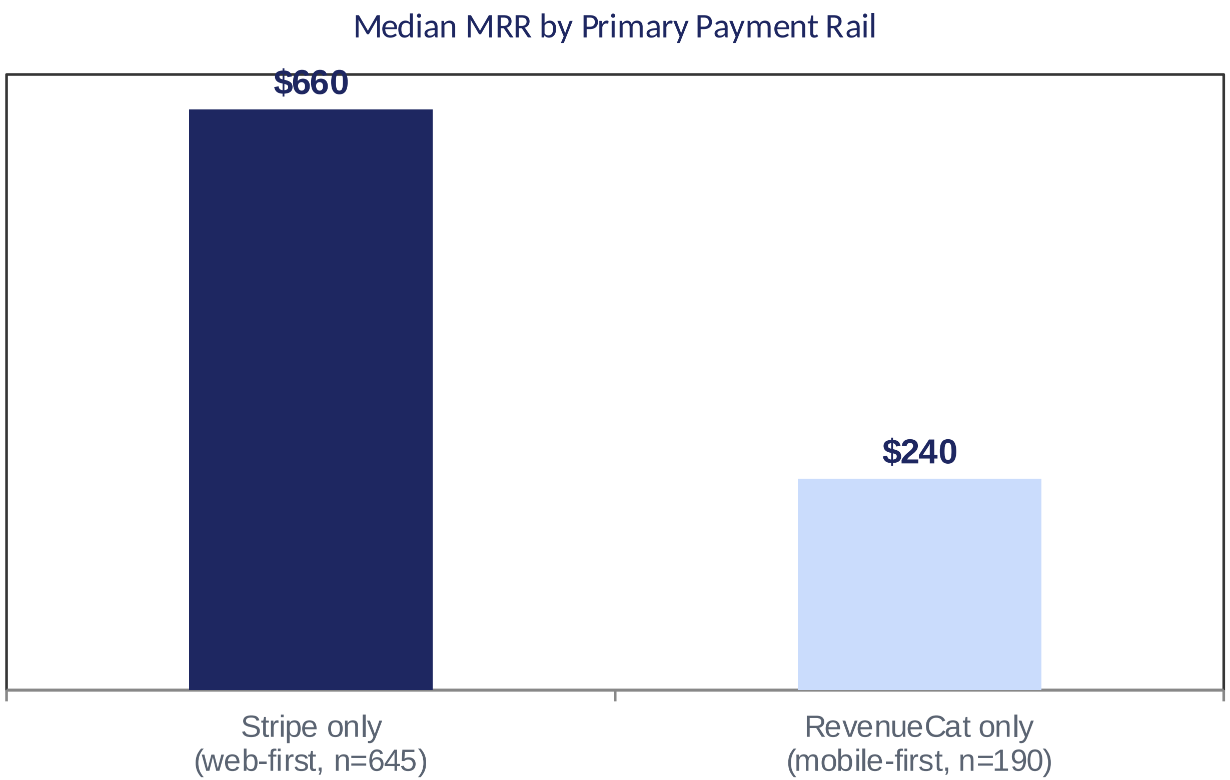
5.7x

higher median MRR for B2B companies vs. B2C companies

- B2B companies (n=255) post a median MRR of $1,036 — nearly 6x the B2C median of $181 (n=401).
- Mixed B2B/B2C companies sit in between at $352 median MRR.
- This gap dwarfs most of the category-level differences seen on the previous slide.

SO WHAT: Audience type is one of the strongest revenue predictors in this dataset — B2B businesses monetize far more effectively than B2C at the same maturity.

Web-First Products Out-Earn Mobile-First Products



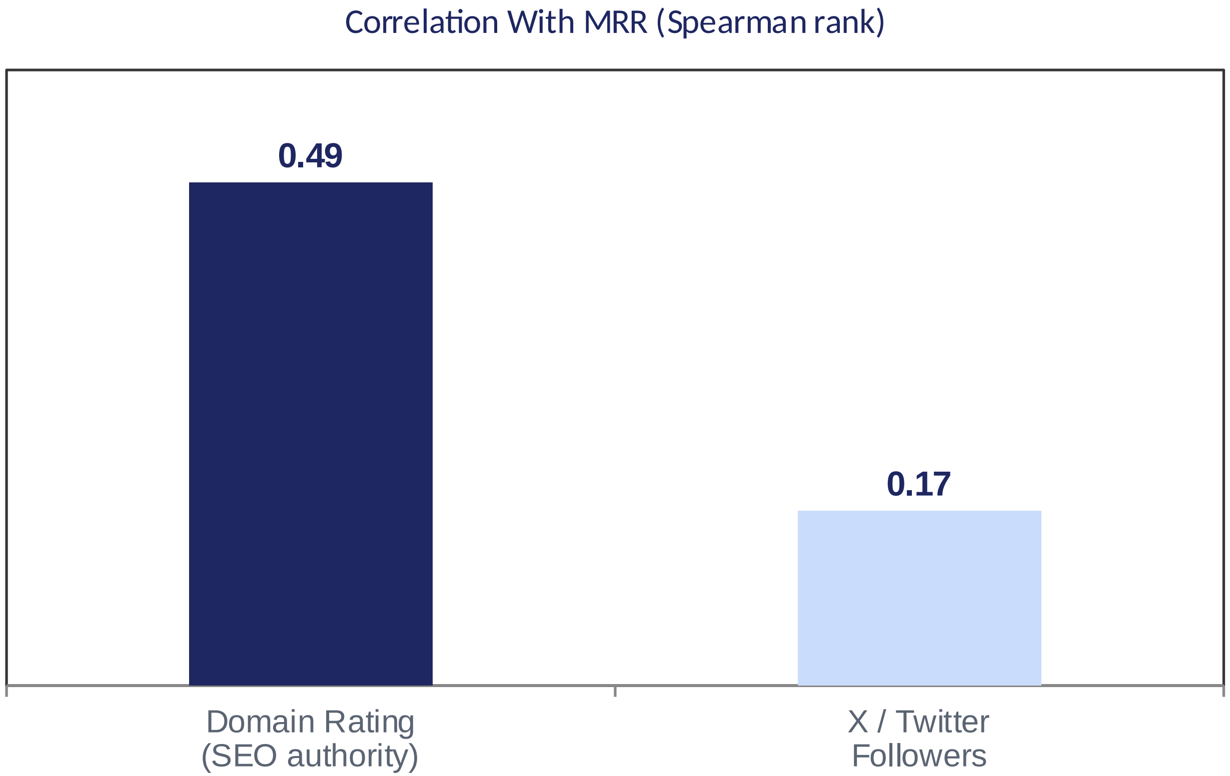
2.75x

higher median MRR for Stripe-only (web) vs. RevenueCat-only (mobile) companies

- Payment provider acts as a proxy for distribution model: Stripe-only listings are predominantly web/desktop products; RevenueCat-only listings are predominantly mobile apps.
- Web-first products post a median MRR of $660 vs. $240 for mobile-first — nearly 3x higher.
- 645 of 1,000 companies (65%) run on Stripe alone; 190 (19%) run on RevenueCat alone.

SO WHAT: Distribution channel is a meaningful revenue signal — web-first subscription products are monetizing noticeably better than mobile-first apps in this sample.

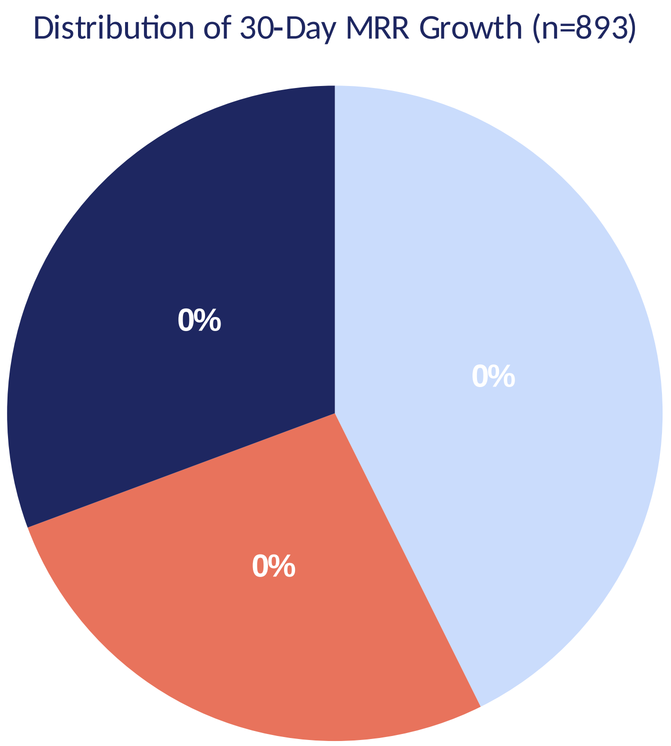
SEO Strength Beats Social Following as a Revenue Signal



- Domain authority (a site's SEO strength) moves with MRR far more consistently than social reach does — a rank correlation of 0.49 vs. just 0.17 for X/Twitter followers.
- Raw follower counts are a weak, noisy signal in this dataset: many high-follower accounts monetize poorly, and many high-MRR companies have small followings.
- Because rankings, not raw values, drive this relationship, it holds even with the dataset's heavy skew toward a few outlier companies.

SO WHAT: If you can only track one external signal as a leading indicator of revenue, domain/SEO authority is far more informative than social media following.

Growth Is the Exception, Not the Rule



- Only 31% of companies with known growth data grew their MRR in the last 30 days.
- 43% were exactly flat, and 27% actively declined — most businesses in this dataset are holding steady or losing ground month-to-month.
- Extreme growth figures (some companies show 1,000%+ MRR growth) are almost always a small-base effect — e.g., going from $10 to $500 — not real momentum. Always check the absolute dollar change behind a growth percentage.

SO WHAT: Don't assume growth is the default state — most companies here are flat or shrinking, and headline growth percentages need an absolute-dollar sanity check.

The Best Performers Often Choose to Stay Anonymous

13%
of all listings are anonymous ('Stealth Company' / 'Hidden Business')

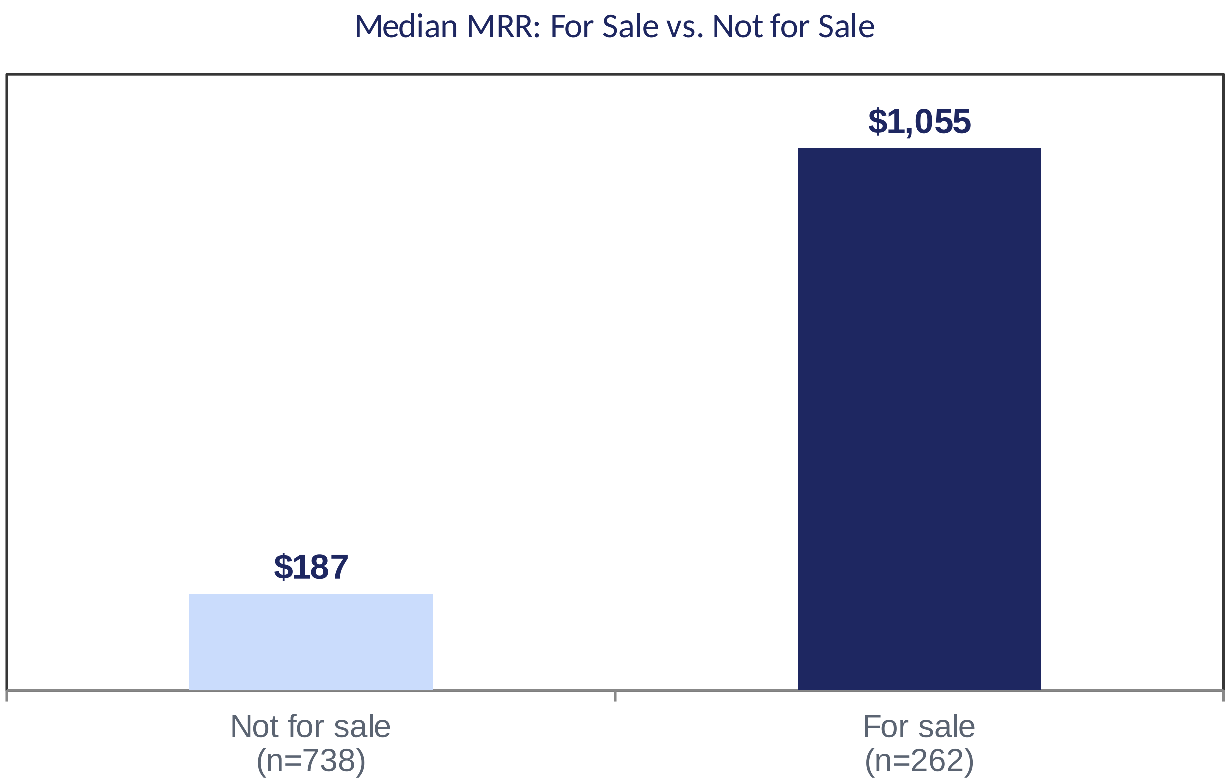
30x
higher median MRR for anonymous listings ($8,495) vs. the overall median ($282)

36%
of the top 100 earners are anonymous — nearly 3x their 13% share of listings

- Anonymous listings are not underperformers hiding poor results — quite the opposite. Their typical (median) MRR is roughly 30x the dataset-wide median.
- They are heavily over-represented among top earners: 13% of all listings but 36% of the top 100 companies by MRR.
- A plausible read: successful operators anonymize to protect a competitive edge, avoid copycats, or keep a low profile while scaling.

SO WHAT: Anonymity in this dataset correlates with strength, not weakness — don't discount 'Stealth Company' listings as low-quality data.

For-Sale Businesses Skew Healthier, Not Weaker



26%
of all 1,000 companies are currently marked for sale

- 262 of 1,000 companies (26%) are listed for sale on the marketplace.
- For-sale companies post a median MRR of $1,055 — 5.6x higher than the $187 median for companies not for sale.
- This suggests sellers here are mostly offloading working, revenue-generating businesses — not distressed or failed ones.

SO WHAT: Being listed for sale is not a red flag in this dataset — for-sale companies are, if anything, the stronger half of the population.

Asking Prices Aren't Consistently Anchored to Revenue

0x - 327x
range of asking-price-to-revenue multiples among for-sale companies (n=262)

2.3x
median asking-price multiple — most listings cluster far below the extremes

r = 0.84
correlation between asking price and trailing 12-month revenue — a real but imperfect relationship

- The typical listing prices at roughly 2.3x recent revenue — but the full range spans from 0x to over 300x, an enormous spread for what should be a fairly mechanical calculation.
- Asking price does track revenue reasonably well overall (r = 0.84), so pricing isn't random — but the wide multiple range shows sellers (or the market) aren't pricing consistently.
- For buyers, this spread is an opportunity: disciplined, multiple-aware shopping can surface underpriced, healthy businesses.

SO WHAT: Pricing in this marketplace is directionally sound but far from efficient — there's real room for informed buyers to find mispriced deals.

SO WHAT

Four Takeaways for Anyone Using This Data

1. **Don't chase category hype** — AI has the most listings but a below-median payoff. Audience type (B2B vs. B2C) and distribution channel (web vs. mobile) predict revenue far better than category alone.

2. **Track domain authority as a leading indicator** — SEO/domain strength (r about 0.49) is a far more reliable revenue signal than social follower counts (r about 0.17) - worth building into any screening process.

3. **Treat growth headlines with skepticism** — Only 31% of companies grew MRR in the last 30 days; triple-digit growth percentages are usually a small-base artifact. Always check absolute dollars.

4. **Look past the loudest listings** — Anonymous 'Stealth' companies are 13% of listings but 36% of top earners, and for-sale companies skew healthier than average - the best opportunities aren't always the most visible.

What to Trust — and What to Treat as Directional

HIGH CONFIDENCE

- Core revenue fields — MRR, 30-day/3-month/12-month/all-time revenue, active subscriptions — are 100% complete across all 1,000 rows.
- on_sale and asking_price fields are internally consistent (999 of 1,000 rows match expected logic).
- Safe to use for revenue-concentration, growth-bucket, and marketplace-pricing analysis at the full-population level.

TREAT AS DIRECTIONAL

- Visitor traffic (visitors_30d) is missing for 82% of companies — any traffic-based conclusion covers a small, possibly non-representative subset.
- Category is missing for 27%, country for 24%, and 30-day growth rate for 11% of companies — segment-level breakdowns describe the labeled subset, not the full population.
- pricing_model is inconsistently formatted free text and was not used for aggregate analysis in this deck.

SO WHAT: Revenue and marketplace conclusions in this deck are solid; category, geography, and traffic conclusions should be read as directional, not definitive.

IN ONE LINE

A small share of businesses capture most of the revenue - and audience type, distribution channel, and SEO strength predict who they are far better than category or buzz.

Questions & Discussion

Based on TrustMRR dataset, frozen 30 Jul 2026